

Firearms Trace Data: Virginia - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Virginia in Calendar Year 2023

14,874

Firearm Types with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	11,126
Rifles	1,465
Revolvers	1,056
Shotguns	772
Silencers	183
Machineguns	103
Other*	169

* Other includes Derringers, Machinegun Conversion Devices, Any Other Weapons, Receivers/Frames, Unknown Types, Combinations and Destructive Devices.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	6,875
.40 Cal	1,605
.22 Cal	1,025
.45 Cal	843

.380 Cal	695
12GA	608
.38 Cal	408
5.56mm	373
7.62mm	322
.357 Cal	290

NOTE: There were 1,503 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 327 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Weapon Offense	4,184
Firearm Under Investigation	3,297
Possession of Weapon	2,038
Found Firearm	1,286
Carrying Concealed Weapon	949
Dangerous Drugs	570
Homicide	396
Suicide	335
Aggravated Assault	319
Property Crimes	239

NOTE: There were 1,261 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Virginia	10,168
North Carolina	364
Florida	193
Georgia	170
South Carolina	115
Tennessee	113
Texas	109
Pennsylvania	101
Kentucky	100
West Virginia	90
Maryland	88
Ohio	87
California	48
Alabama	46
Washington	36

NOTE: An additional 33 states, the District of Columbia and Puerto Rico accounted for 504 other traces. The source state was identified in 12,332 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	1,120
3 Months to Under 7 Months	949
7 Months to Under 1 Year	976
1 Year to Under 2 Years	1,906
2 Years to Under 3 Years	1,799
3 Years and Over	5,546

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Virginia Average Time-to-Crime: **5.90 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	466
18 to 21	1,477
22 to 24	1,371
25 to 30	2,120
31 to 40	2,494
41 to 50	1,316
Over 50	1,618

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Virginia Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Richmond	1,668
Virginia Beach	1,479
Newport News	1,131
Norfolk	1,013
Chesapeake	776
Roanoke	501
Henrico	491
Fredericksburg	477
Hampton	444
Danville	370

NOTE: There were 435 additional municipalities that accounted for 6,506 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 18 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Virginia. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Virginia.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024